

RATING COOKOUT FOODS FOR STAYING LEAN

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Jul 11, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/ion5wYlo4d0> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter scores popular cookout foods from 1–10 for staying lean, rewarding high-protein, low-calorie options like shrimp and chicken while penalizing calorie-dense traps like hot dogs, potato salad, and chips.

Contents

-  Grilled Chicken Skewers
-  Potato Salad
-  Shrimp Kebabs
-  Corn on the Cob
-  Hot Dog
-  Burger
-  Watermelon
-  Chips
-  Steak
-  The Bottom Line

Grilled Chicken Skewers 0:00

- **Rating: 10/10**
 - Skewered presentation signals it's likely chicken breast — a super lean cut
 - Grilling adds no extra calories to the meat
 - Easy to eat, no calorie-heavy additions involved

Potato Salad 0:07

- **Rating: 3/10**
 - Loaded with calories from mayo-based dressing
 - Additional warning: some people (jokingly called out as "Caucasian counterparts") add raisins, which pile on more calories and sugar
 - Recommended to avoid at cookouts when trying to stay lean

Shrimp Kebabs 0:21

- **Rating: 10/10**

- Called "probably the best kebab you can get"
- Shrimp is almost entirely protein with very few calories
- Grilling on a kebab keeps it clean without adding extra calories

Corn on the Cob 0:31

- **Rating: 6/10**

- Corn itself is not terrible, but the problem is preparation
- "You ain't raw dogging the corn on the cob" — butter is essentially mandatory to make it taste good
- All that added butter significantly increases the calorie count
- Better options exist at a cookout

Hot Dog 0:42

- **Rating: 2/10**

- Referred to as "the glizzy"
- Core problem: the protein-to-calorie ratio is way off — you get relatively little protein for a high calorie cost

Burger 0:47

- **Rating: 6/10 with bun, ~8/10 without**

- The patty itself is a decent protein source
- Dropping the bun cuts calories meaningfully and bumps the rating up by roughly 2 points
- Simple swap with a real impact on staying lean

Watermelon 0:53

- **Rating: 10/10**

- Humorously acknowledged the stereotype before giving the rating
- Very low in calories despite being sweet
- Key insight: "Ain't nobody ever got fed off watermelon" — it's not calorie-dense enough to cause fat gain

Chips 1:03

- **Rating: 1/10**

- Bluntly called "trash"
- No elaboration needed — high calories, low protein, easy to overeat

Steak 1:06

- **Rating: 8/10 (averaged across cuts)**
 - Rating varies significantly by cut:
 - Filet mignon → ~9/10 (leaner, high protein)
 - Ribeye → lower rating (higher fat content, more calories)
 - Averaged to 8 to account for the range of cuts served at cookouts



The Bottom Line 1:15

- The overarching rule that supersedes all individual ratings:

"You can eat any food as long as you're getting the right amount of calories for your goal. You got to track those calories."

- Calorie tracking is the non-negotiable foundation — food choice matters, but total intake is what ultimately drives results

Food	Rating	Key Reason
Grilled Chicken Skewers	10/10	Lean breast meat, grilled clean
Shrimp Kebabs	10/10	Almost all protein, grilled
Watermelon	10/10	Very low calorie density
Steak (avg)	8/10	Depends on cut; filet = 9, ribeye = lower
Burger (no bun)	~8/10	Bun removal cuts calories significantly
Corn on the Cob	6/10	Butter requirement adds calories
Burger (with bun)	6/10	Bun adds unnecessary calories
Potato Salad	3/10	Calorie-dense, mayo + possible raisins
Hot Dog	2/10	Poor protein-to-calorie ratio
Chips	1/10	High calorie, low protein, "trash"